

Lesson 1

The Foundation - What Makes This Work

Hello and welcome to the course. If you're here, my guess is that you have probably tried a lot to feel better. You've probably read so many books and done so much research and tried therapy and protocols and programs that made a promise to help you feel better, and some of it might've worked. Might've helped for a minute, but you're still here and there's a reason for that.

Because you're still dealing with a nervous system that is stuck on high alert and that has been sensitized. And I get that on a soul level because I spent a very long time there too. I am not a therapist. I'm not a medical professional. What I am is someone who spent 20 years trying to fix herself and then finally figured out what would actually make the difference.

I have a background in learning everything that has to do with human psychology. I spent six years coaching women through behavior change. I have logged hundreds of hours studying the nervous system, chronic symptoms, and why people stay stuck. I've lived it. Chronic anxiety, chronic insomnia, and chronic physical symptoms and pain.

What changed for me was not another protocol, it was not a step-by-step process. It was changing how I responded. My chronic anxiety is gone. My insomnia is gone. The health OCD, constant checking, reassurance, seeking certainty, chasing is all gone too. I still have some physical symptoms that are resolving, but they're less frequent, less intense, and continuing to get better every single day.

I am not waiting to feel better to live my life. I live without fear now, and that part is already so different. My baseline is different, my capacity is different, and my life is completely different. That is what this course is about. The single most important thing that you can change is how you respond when something uncomfortable shows up.

That's what this course is teaching you to do. It's not about fixing. It's not about making specific symptoms disappear. It is helping you to stop reinforcing the alarm. So your system that has been severely sensitized can finally do the work it needs to do and settle down. This course is built the way that it is built on purpose.

So before we go any further, I wanna be really clear about how it works and. Doesn't, you are not going to get a checklist. You are not going to get a step-by-step daily protocol. There's no set of steps you need to follow correctly, and that's not because steps are always a bad thing to have. It's because what they require are a few certain things to actually work.

Things like stability, consistency, executive functioning, and access to that higher part of your brain and a lowered level of fear. Unfortunately, a sensitized nervous system does not reliably have access to many of those things at all. So instead of helping steps will often just become another way for you to monitor yourself, another way to feel like you are doing something wrong and another thing that you feel like you're just performing to get your checklist for the day.

What your nervous system actually learns from is patterns, especially what happens after either a sensation, a symptom, or a feeling shows up for you. That's why this course teaches principles instead of protocols because the work is not complicated, but it is actually very uncomfortable to apply in real life.

Protocols are gonna ask, did I do this the right way? Whereas principles are gonna ask, what kind of response am I reinforcing right now? Protocols tend to create hyper vigilance, pressure, urgency, and this constant sense that you're behind or doing something wrong. Principles do something different. They apply in your real actual life, in real moments.

They do not require perfect execution. They reduce urgency instead of adding on top of it, and they help you to build that self-trust instead of you just learning to be compliant to a protocol. This course is designed to change how you respond, not give you more things to do, and to manage the core that everything hangs on is simple.

What you react to, you wire. But what you respond to differently, you rewire. So what do I mean when I say soft regulation? Because I'm not talking about being passive. I'm not talking about laying down and accepting defeat. I'm not talking about letting everything slide. And crawling back into bed for the rest of your life.

Soft regulation is soft because we put down the fight, the resistance, the perfectionism, the forcing, the fixing, all of that is very hard and it makes everything a lot harder. Soft regulation means we're removing the force from the way you respond to your nervous system and anything it throws at you.

Sensations, symptoms, feelings, thoughts. That does not mean. Avoiding discomfort or letting fear run your life or waiting to feel better before you do anything. It means that you stop attacking yourself in order to heal you. Stop overmanaging yourself in order to get better. We have to stop trying to overpower the sensations, stop treating discomfort like it's this immediate problem that needs to be solved.

You're still gonna have to show up. You're still gonna have to live your life, and you're still gonna feel very uncomfortable. Sometimes, or maybe oftentimes, especially at the beginning of this process, but what changes is you stop meeting those hard moments with force and fixing an urgency. Soft regulation is teaching you a new way to respond to your nervous system, where we are going to remove the urgency, self attack, and force, and life still continues.

This course is not here to make you feel calm all the time. It is here to help you to stop reinforcing your nervous system alarm, lower your baseline stress, build capacity to feel and live again, it

because I need you to understand that your symptoms as hard and horrific as they are, are not the problem.

They are not the reason that you can't get rid of them. A solution to your symptoms is not the issue that we're looking for. Changing the response to them is, so here's something that is very important for you to remember and I wanna tell you from the get-go. For most people, fear will be the first thing that heals.

Your relationship to the symptoms is gonna change before the symptoms themselves do. So that shift where fear is no longer what is running your life is going to be the earliest sign that something is working. When you look for whether or not you are being successful, look at the fear. Look at if the fear is reducing, that's what we're working with here.

Let's talk about how to use this course. 'cause there are a few things that really matter. Please listen slowly. Repeat lessons. This course is in the format that it's in so that you have the ability to listen and re-listen to lessons with ease. In this case, repetition is going to matter more than completion.

It's not about getting to the end. It's about listening and applying in a way that this info becomes more than. An insight, it becomes something that is embodied for you. It's something that you know and you experience in your body versus what you've done up until this point, which is intellectualize everything in your mind.

So do not rush to figure everything out and to play it. Every concept that you've learned, let the shifts happen on their own. Really remember that we're removing the force here, and please expect discomfort. Do not expect instant relief. If you notice some instant relief or some fast relief, that's amazing, but that's not the moment where things are really changing and rewiring.

So when discomfort rises, remind yourself. She told me this is part of the process because the work that I'm teaching you in this course is here to help you lower your baseline stress and desensitize your sensitized nervous system. It does not eliminate activation altogether. We're trying to grow your capacity to manage the activation so it doesn't put you down and out.

Everything. Something comes in that activates you, so you do not need to fix yourself to be here. That is no longer the goal. There is nothing broken. It's just working a little bit. Too well, it's too sensitized, and our work here is to desensitize it. That is why this course is going to give you very clear direction.

It's not gonna give you rules and steps and a process and a protocol. I know that gives this false sense of certainty, but that's not the way this process works. Your system doesn't need any more overload, so if you find yourself listening for those instructions on exactly what to do, you're listening for the wrong thing.

Let's get started.